WEEK 10 · LECTURE L1 OF 3 · UNIT IV

The Gig and Platform Economy

How platform work works, who it serves, and India's emerging legal frame.

Part 1 Cold calls on your pod's Round 5 KPI and dashboard design

Part 2 How platform work works; the Indian landscape and law

Part 3 Fairness, social security and data for gig workers

Read NITI Aayog (2022); Code on Social Security, 2020

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PART 1 · COLD CALLS

Three questions on your pod's Round 5 design

1 · The headline

What was your dashboard's headline sentence, and which decision does it drive?

2 · The counter metric

Which counter metric did you pair with your main KPI, and what gaming would it reveal?

3 · The gap

Which population does your dashboard not see at all?

HINT Gig partners sit in Gig_Workforce, never in Employee_Master. Most HR dashboards miss them.

PART 2 · INDIA'S GIG ECONOMY

Scale, and the legal frame now emerging

Item	What it says
NITI Aayog (2022)	About 7.7 million gig workers in 2020 to 21, projected to reach 23.5 million by 2029 to 30
Code on Social Security, 2020	Recognizes gig and platform workers; social security schemes funded partly by aggregators (1% to 2% of annual turnover, capped at 5% of payments to workers)
Rajasthan Act, 2023	First state law: registers platform workers and aggregators, a welfare board and fund financed by a fee on transactions, and a grievance route

THE LAYERS National frame (SS2020), state enforcement (Rajasthan), and the platform's own policies.

PART 3 · GREENLEAF'S PARTNERS

Three tiers, three different lives

Tier (partners)	Monthly earnings	Allocation score	Grievances (6 months)	SS2020 enrolled	Churned
Bronze (34)	₹7,361	31.5	2.6	20.6%	32.4%
Silver (170)	₹12,771	56.4	1.2	37.6%	0%
Gold (96)	₹19,014	81.6	1.1	55.2%	0%

THE GAP

Bronze partners earn less, complain more, are least protected, and leave. Enrollment gap Gold to Bronze: 34.6 percentage points. Source: Gig_Workforce.

Going deeper: the theory underneath platform work

The next slides set out Coase on the boundary of the firm, Atkinson's flexible firm, Kalleberg on precarious work, and the RAISE approach: what each claims, how it works, where it breaks, and what it means at GreenLeaf.

THEORY IN DEPTH · COASE (1937)

Why firms exist, and why work leaves them

THE CORE IDEA

Firms hire people when coordinating inside costs less than buying work in the market.

HOW IT WORKS

Platforms cut the cost of market coordination, so more work moves outside the firm.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Transaction costs are hard to measure, and power, not only cost, shapes the boundary.

AT GREENLEAF

That is why 300 delivery partners sit outside Employee_Master, and why their protection depends on law, not HR policy.

THEORY IN DEPTH · ATKINSON (1984)

The flexible firm: core and periphery

THE CORE IDEA

Firms keep a stable core of skilled staff and a flexible periphery of temporary, part-time and contracted workers.

HOW IT WORKS

Functional flexibility in the core; numerical flexibility in the periphery.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Critics say it described an intention more than a widespread reality.

AT GREENLEAF GreenLeaf's gig partners are its numerical periphery. The risk is a two-class workforce.

THEORY IN DEPTH · KALLEBERG (2009)

Precarious work is a choice of design

THE CORE IDEA

Work that is uncertain, unstable and insecure, with risks shifted from employer to worker.

HOW IT WORKS

Driven by global competition, weaker unions and new technology that eases outsourcing.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Precarity varies by country, skill and welfare system.

AT GREENLEAF Volatile earnings and no health cover make Bronze partners precarious by design, not by chance.

THEORY IN DEPTH · NITI AAYOG (2022)

RAISE: implementing social security for gig workers

THE CORE IDEA

The report proposed a RAISE approach to extend social security to platform workers.

HOW IT WORKS

Recognize varied platform work; Allow innovative financing; Incorporate platform, worker and job interests; Support workers to subscribe; Ensure benefits are accessible.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

A policy proposal; implementation depends on states and platforms.

AT GREENLEAF

GreenLeaf can apply RAISE directly: help Bronze partners enroll, starting with the 79% not enrolled.

TAKEAWAYS

Three things to carry out of this lecture

1

Gig work sits outside the firm by design, and outside most HR dashboards.

2

India's frame has national, state and platform layers.

3

Bronze partners earn least, are least protected, and leave.

NEXT Hybrid and flexible work.